MONTHLY UPDATE

Equatorial Guinea: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Public debate and participation in policymaking

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Cybersecurity

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Digital Payments and Fintech · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

INCLUSION
Access to services

DATA
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Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL DIGITAL STRATEGY

- **El Ministerio de Telecomunicaciones acelera la transformación digital con el respaldo del Grupo Banco Mundial** — Oficina de Información y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 2 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Ministry of Transport, Telecommunications and Civil Aviation opened a four-day working session in Malabo on 2 September 2026 with eight World Bank Group specialists. Its aims are to finish and validate the national digital economy strategy, complete the sector's legal framework and prepare a World Bank-financed project, which would be the Bank's first operation in the country in 35 years.

Legislation and regulation

TAXATION OF FOREIGN DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **El Gobierno exige a Meta tributar en Guinea Ecuatorial y ordena centralizar la comercialización de Starlink en ORTEL** — AHORAEG, 9 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's vice-president, Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue, gave the state operator ORTEL sole legal authority to sell Starlink satellite internet, under the state secretariat for artificial intelligence, and ordered contracts made outside official channels cancelled. He also tasked a commission with discussing payments to the state with Meta, which he said has done business in the country without paying.

- **Guinée équatoriale : contribution des plateformes numériques en discussion** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea intends a mechanism letting the state capture part of the revenue large digital platforms generate in its market, a question sharpened where companies operate from abroad. The vice-president asked in Malabo for talks to be opened with one such platform and with comparable alternatives.

PRESS LAW REVISION

- **La Camara de los Diputados ha aprobado tres proyectos de leyes presentados por el Gobierno** — Pagina Oficial del Gobierno de la Republica de Guinea Ecuatorial, 11 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Chamber of Deputies unanimously approved three government bills on 11 September 2026: reforms of the Mining and Hydrocarbons laws and a new press freedom law. The mining reform creates a national geological service, a mining registry and cadastre, a national mining management platform and a digital geological registry, with licences awarded by international tender as the general rule. The press law replaces a 1997 law that does not cover digital journalism.

- **La nueva Ley de Libertad de Prensa avanza al Pleno del Senado tras el consenso alcanzado por la comisión** — AHORAEG, 8 October 2026

  An Equatorial Guinea Senate committee approved by consensus its report on a new Press Freedom and Journalism Bill and sent it to the full Senate. The bill gives digital and audiovisual journalists the same protections and duties, sets a right of access to public information with deadlines and appeals, separates editorial oversight from spectrum management by ORTEL and creates a college of journalists.

SATELLITE BROADBAND SALES ROUTED THROUGH THE REGULATOR

- **Equatorial Guinea: Starlink sales to run via ORTEL** — Tech.Africa, 15 September 2026

  All satellite internet sales are to run through the telecommunications regulator, under the supervision of the artificial intelligence state secretariat, and contracts citizens obtained outside official channels are to be cancelled, decided at a working session on 9 September.

LEY 7/2024 ON SOCIAL MEDIA AND COMPUTER CRIME

- **El despacho que representa a S.E. Nguema Obiang Mangue explica las acciones contra Diario Rombe y otras tres personas** — Oficina de Informacion y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 17 September 2026

  Lawyers for Equatorial Guinea's vice-president Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue said they lodged four criminal complaints at a Malabo court on 16 September 2026 against four people, including Mocache Massoko of the online paper Diario Rombe. The complaints rest on articles 2 and 60 of Law 7/2024 on social media and cybercrime; article 2 is invoked to reach conduct outside the country.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

PROSECUTION AND ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION COORDINATION PROTOCOL

- **Fiscalía y Comisión Anticorrupción pactan coordinación permanente para luchar contra la corrupción en Guinea Ecuatorial** — Revista Real Equatorial Guinea, 4 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Attorney General Anatolio Nzang Nguema Mangue and the new head of the anti-corruption commission, Santiago Casto Nvono Bibang, agreed on 3 September 2026 to set up permanent coordination against corruption. The plan includes liaison points, a protocol for exchanging information, periodic review meetings and joint training for officials.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

STARLINK SERVICE AND ITS CENTRALISED DISTRIBUTION

- **El Gobierno exige a Meta tributar en Guinea Ecuatorial y ordena centralizar la comercialización de Starlink en ORTEL** — AHORAEG, 9 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **Guinée équatoriale / Internet satellitaire : Starlink officiellement lancé** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 9 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's vice-president, Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue, announced on 9 September 2026 the official launch of SpaceX's Starlink satellite internet service. Sales will be centralised, requests handled by the telecoms regulator Ortel, and earlier connections made with foreign details deactivated. The government also plans talks with Meta on charging fees for use of its applications in the country.

BLOCK ON FACEBOOK AND TIKTOK WITH THROTTLED BANDWIDTH

- **Guinée équatoriale : coupure de Facebook et TikTok** — Seneweb, 16 September 2026

  Facebook and TikTok have been unreachable in Equatorial Guinea without a VPN since 2 September 2026, with internet speeds throttled, AFP reports. The restrictions followed a viral video accusing Vice-President Teodoro Nguema Obiang of corruption; its author was arrested.

GETESA NETWORK MODERNISATION

- **GETESA ahorrará 262 millones de francos CFA al mes para reinvertirlos en la mejora de la red nacional** — AhoraEG, 8 October 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Vice-President Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue told the finance ministry on 7 October 2026 to investigate and urgently release financing for state operator GETESA's network expansion agreement with Huawei, which Treasury payment arrears have slowed. GETESA will cancel non-essential maintenance contracts until December, saving over 262 million CFA francs a month for reinvestment in the network.

Cybersecurity

ALLEGED LEAK OF OFFICIAL DOCUMENTS OF THE PRESIDENCY OF THE GOVERNMENT

- **El vicepresidente revela nombres vinculados a una presunta masiva filtración de documentos oficiales de Guinea Ecuatorial** — Revista Real Equatorial Guinea, 9 October 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's vice-president, Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue, named on X the alleged members of a network leaking official documents from the Presidency of the Government. He alleged that a registry official extracted several years of administrative files and handed a hard drive to a third party under the pretext of a project to digitise the Presidency's archives. The account is the government's; no court finding is reported.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

PRESIDENCY ORDER 3/2025 PROHIBITING CASH COLLECTION OF STATE REVENUE

- **Reunión en el Ministerio de Transportes sobre la propuesta para digitalizar el pago de impuestos en la Administración Pública** — Guinea Ecuatorial Press, 28 September 2026

An Equatorial Guinean e-wallet provider presented itself to the transport ministry as a channel for collecting state revenue, citing a 2025 Presidency order that bans cash payment of any tax or fee in the administration. The company is seeking a favourable technical review.

Sectoral management information systems

SYDONIA CUSTOMS SYSTEM EXTENSION OUTSIDE MALABO

- **Support for the Reinforcement of the mobilization of non-oil revenues** — PAMFP, 15 September 2026

  An undated page from Equatorial Guinea's public-finance modernisation programme sets out plans for a unique taxpayer identification number and an integrated revenue system linking the tax, customs and treasury administrations. It also lists extending the SYDONIA customs system to seven sites outside Malabo; no timetable or delivery status is given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITAL BOLETIN OFICIAL DEL ESTADO

- **El Gobierno pone en marcha el Boletín Oficial del Estado digital** — Guinea Ecuatorial Press (Oficina de Información y Prensa), 6 October 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's government announced a digital edition of its official gazette at boe.gob.gq, giving free online access to laws, decrees, ministerial orders and circulars with search of past publications.

Inclusion

Access to services

REFUGEE LEGAL FRAMEWORK

- **Equatorial Guinea | Rights Mapping and Analysis Platform** — United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), Rights Mapping and Analysis Platform, 2 September 2026

  UNHCR's rights-mapping platform records that Equatorial Guinea is party to the 1951 Refugee Convention, its 1967 Protocol and the 1969 OAU Convention but has no domestic law for refugee status determination, so asylum seekers have no formal procedure to apply. It acceded to the Kampala Convention on displaced persons in 2019 and lists five asylum seekers.

Data

National statistics

STATISTICS FROM ADMINISTRATIVE RECORDS

- **INEGE inicia una gira por los servicios estadísticos de los ministerios para consolidar el Sistema Estadístico Nacional** — Revista Real Equatorial Guinea, 3 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's statistics institute, INEGE, began a tour of ministries' statistical services on 2 September 2026, starting with the interior and education ministries, to assess their capacity and needs. Both were found short of working materials. The tour runs to 9 September under resolutions of the National Statistics Council's session of 27 August 2026.

- **INEGE presenta la novena edición del Anuario Estadístico y llama a convertir los datos en decisiones** — AHORAEG, 25 September 2026

> Equatorial Guinea's statistics institute INEGE presented the ninth edition of the national Statistical Yearbook in Malabo, covering the last five years. It named stronger administrative registers, digitised processes and interoperable information systems as outstanding challenges, and announced a fifth population and housing census and a first agricultural census, with no dates.

Geopolitics

EU activities

> EUROPEAN UNION DIGITAL COOPERATION

- **Guinea Ecuatorial - Asociaciones Internacionales - Comisión Europea** — Comisión Europea, Dirección General de Asociaciones Internacionales (DG INTPA), 2 September 2026

  The European Commission's country page states that the EU has no delegation in Equatorial Guinea; cooperation is supervised from its delegation in Yaoundé, Cameroon. Equatorial Guinea received no bilateral allocation under the 11th EDF and has no multiannual indicative programme for 2021-2027, but takes part in thematic civil-society and human-rights programmes and in regional programmes through ECCAS.

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